

AI Prompt Cheat Sheet

5-part structure that works every time

THE CORE RULE

Role



Task



Context



Constraints



Output

THE PROMPT TEMPLATE

Role Give it a job — executive assistant, COO, marketing advisor, CFO

Task State exactly what you want done

Context Business situation, goals, audience, facts & pasted notes —
most people under-prompt here

Constraints Tone, length, must-haves, and what to avoid

Output Tell it what "done" looks like — bullet list, email, memo, table, action plan, or script

THE 3 VERSIONS YOU'LL USE MOST

VERSION 01

Write Something

Act as my executive communications assistant

Emails, memos, announcements, policies, social posts. Include audience, tone, length, and what to avoid.

VERSION 02

Think Through a Decision

Act as my strategic advisor

Vendor choices, pricing, hiring, tooling. Ask for pros, cons, risks & a clear recommendation.

VERSION 03

Clean Up Messy Input

Act as my chief of staff

Notes, transcripts, meeting summaries. Return a table with owners, deadlines, and risks.

FAST UPGRADE: WEAK PROMPT FIX

- 1 Audience** — Who is this for?
- 2 Business context** — What's going on?
- 3 Must-haves** — What has to be included?
- 4 Final format** — What should the answer look like?

COMMON MISTAKES TO AVOID

- ✗ Asking for too much without structure
- ✗ Giving no business context
- ✗ Not saying who the audience is
- ✗ Not defining the output format
- ✗ Not stating what to avoid
- ✗ Expecting the model to guess what "good" means

THE ONE-LINE VERSION (WHEN YOU'RE IN A HURRY)

Act as my **[role]**. Help me **[task]**. Context: **[facts]**.

Constraints: **[tone · audience · length · must include · avoid]**. Return as: **[format]**.